HGA · LABEL TEMPLATE · V1 · NOV 2026

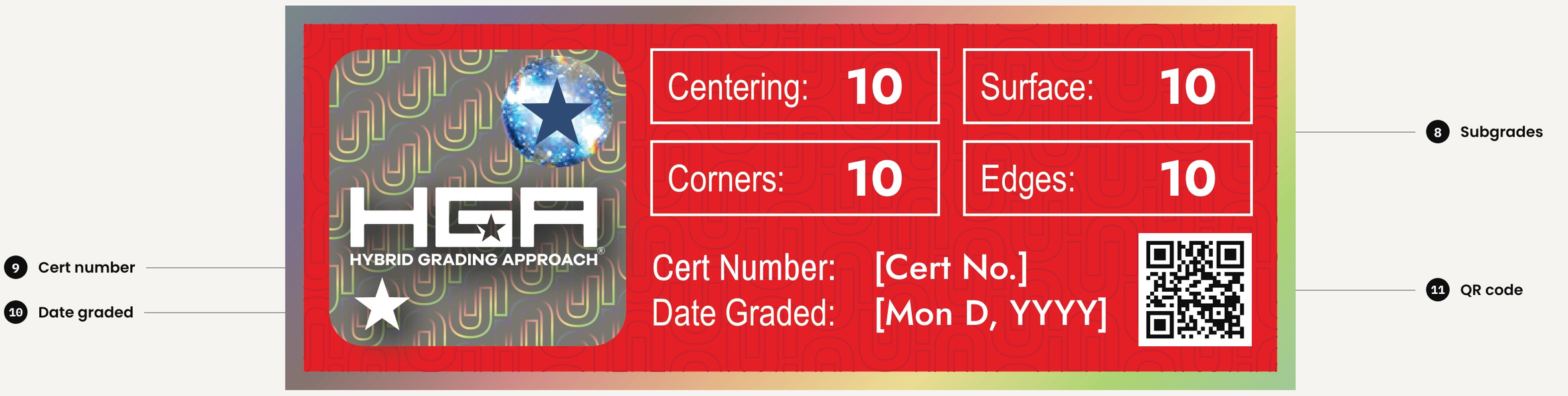
ONE LABEL. EVERY CARD.

Three lines, and every field has one position. The artwork, logo, grade boxes and cert are the current label. Bracketed text shows what prints in each slot.

FRONT



BACK



What prints where

NO.	SLOT	PRINTS	WHEN THERE IS NOTHING TO PRINT
1	**Subject**	Player, character or card name, as printed on the card. Bold, one size, never abbreviated. A long name adds a second line above.	Never empty.
2	**Version**	Subset or rarity, then parallel or variant, joined by a middle dot. Sports: Autographs · Green Blue Lava Lamp. TCG: Holo Rare · 1st Edition.	No parallel: that half drops out. A base card with no parallel prints “Base”.
3	**Release**	Year, manufacturer or game, language when not English, then series. 2024 Topps Chrome Sapphire Edition. 2023 Pokémon Japanese Pokémon Card 151.	Never empty.
4	**Grades**	Card Grade always sits far right. The Auto Grade box prints only when an autograph is graded. Box outlines are 0.5 pt, up from 0.25.	No autograph: the box is removed and Subject gains the width.
5	**Cert**	Eight digits, centred under Card Grade. Unchanged from the current label.	Never empty.
6	**Serial**	Print run as numbered on the card: 2500/4999. Right-aligned on the Version line, beside the parallel it belongs to.	Not numbered: blank.
7	**Card number**	Always starts with #, written as printed: #USA-WL, #199/165, #LOB-001. Right-aligned on the Release line.	No printed number: blank.
8	**Subgrades**	Centering, Corners, Surface, Edges, in whole numbers. Box outlines are 0.5 pt, up from 0.25.	Never empty.
9	**Cert number**	Repeats the front cert, so a photo of the back can be matched to the front. Takes the place of Card Number, which now prints on the front.	Never empty.
10	**Date graded**	Month spelled out, so the date reads the same in every country: Apr 6, 2026.	Never empty.
11	**QR code**	Bottom right, 21 pt square (0.29 in), dark on a white field. Lines up with the right edge of the subgrade boxes and the bottom of the hologram. The code shown is a sample.	Never empty.

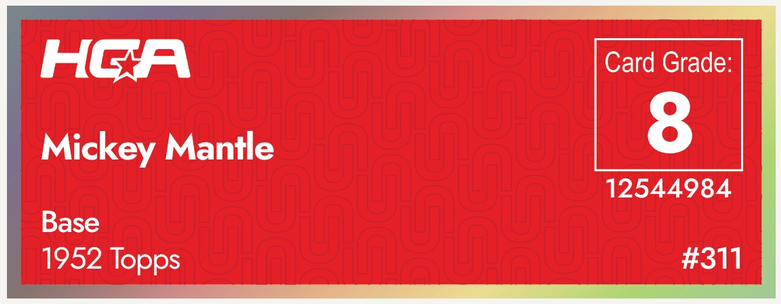
FIFTEEN CARDS, ONE LAYOUT.

Vintage, modern, autographs, two players, non-sport and four card games. The three lines and the right-hand numbers stay where they are on every one.



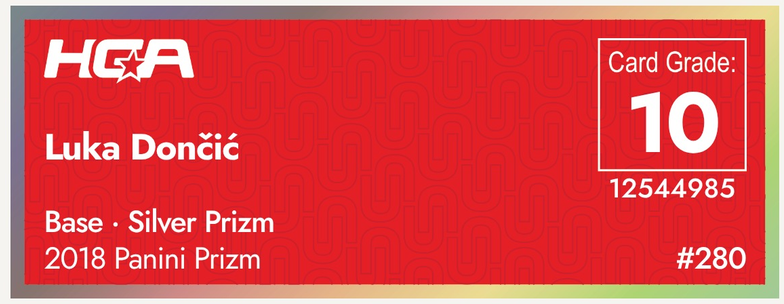
BASEBALL · AUTOGRAPH, PARALLEL, SERIAL

The card on the current label. Every slot filled.



BASEBALL · VINTAGE BASE

No subset, parallel or serial. Line 2 prints “Base” so it is never blank.



BASKETBALL · BASE PARALLEL

Not numbered, so the serial slot stays clear.



BASKETBALL · LONG NAME, SERIAL

A 23-character name holds one line beside a single grade box.



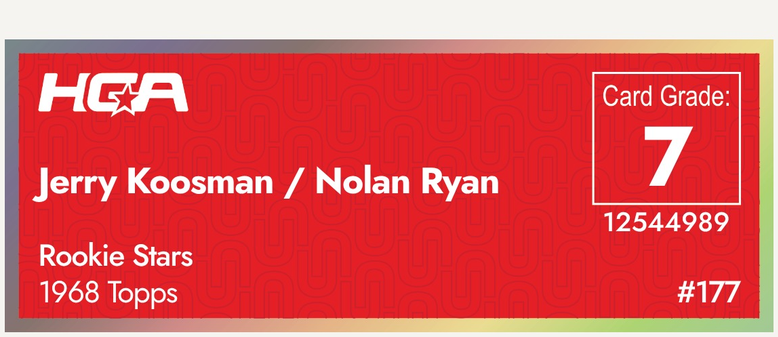
FOOTBALL · TWO GRADES, LONG VERSION

“Autograph” runs over beside the serial. The short form on file prints “Auto”.



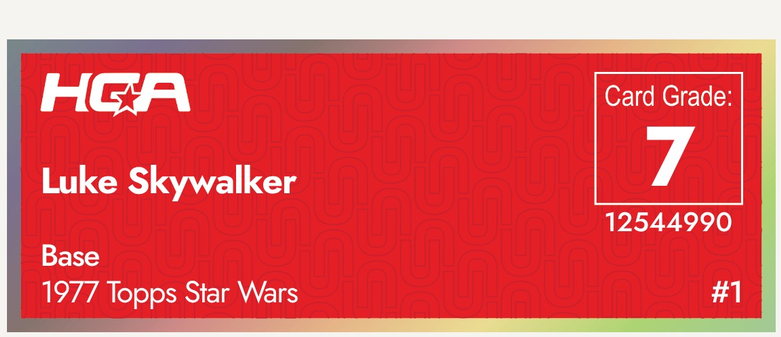
BASEBALL · PROSPECT AUTOGRAPH

The subset drops the repeated “Bowman Chrome”. The longest name that fits beside two boxes.



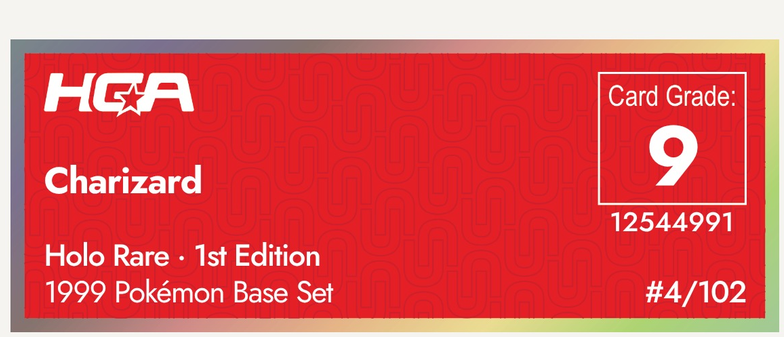
BASEBALL · TWO PLAYERS

Names joined with a slash, in the order printed on the card.



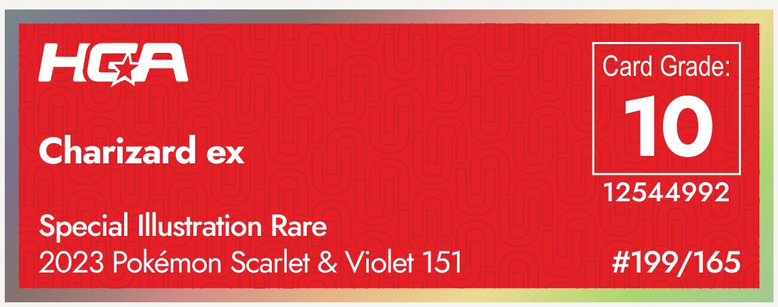
NON-SPORT

The character goes where the player goes.



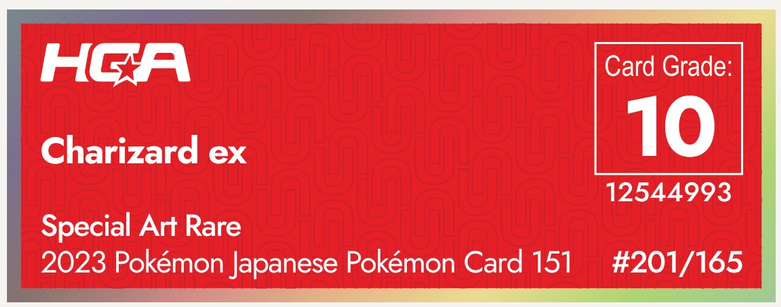
POKÉMON · VINTAGE

Rarity takes the subset slot, edition takes the parallel slot. The # marks 4/102 as a card number.



POKÉMON · MODERN

Rarity spelled out in full, not coded.



POKÉMON · JAPANESE

Language prints right after the game, only when the card is not English.



POKÉMON · PROMO, LONG NAME

About the longest Release line that still fits in full.



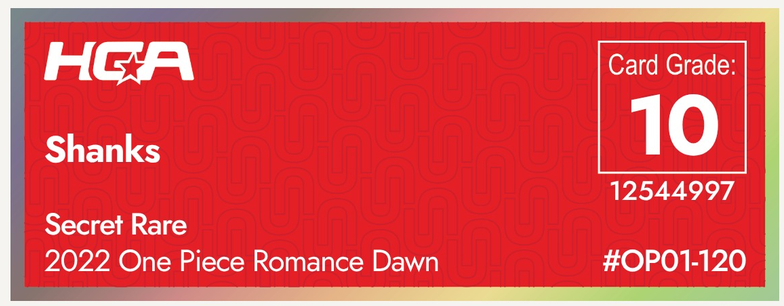
MAGIC · NO CARD NUMBER

Nothing is numbered on the card, so the slot stays blank and nothing shifts.



YU-GI-OH! · SHORT FORM

“Legend of Blue Eyes White Dragon” runs over, so the short form on file prints.



ONE PIECE · LETTERED CARD NUMBER

The number prints exactly as it appears on the card.

HGA · LABEL TEMPLATE · FIELD MAP AND RULES

SAME SLOT, ANY CATEGORY.

What each slot holds for a sports card, a Pokémon card, another card game and a non-sport card. Grey text says what goes in the slot. Black text is an example.

SLOT	SPORTS	POKÉMON	OTHER CARD GAMES	NON-SPORT
LINE 1 · SUBJECT				
Subject	Player name **Wyatt Langford**	Pokémon or card name **Charizard ex**	Card name **Blue-Eyes White Dragon**	Character or title **Luke Skywalker**
LINE 2 · VERSION				
Subset or rarity	Insert or subset. “Base” if none **Autographs**	Rarity **Special Illustration Rare**	Rarity **Ultra Rare**	Subset. “Base” if none **Base**
Parallel or variant	Parallel **Green Blue Lava Lamp**	Edition, finish or stamp **1st Edition**	Edition or foil treatment **1st Edition**	Parallel or variant **Blank when none**
Serial	Print run numbered on the card **2500/4999**	Only when numbered **Blank when none**	Only when numbered **Blank when none**	Only when numbered **Blank when none**
LINE 3 · RELEASE				
Year	Year of the release **2024**	Year of the release **2023**	Year of the release **2002**	Year of the release **1977**
Manufacturer	Card maker **Topps**	The game **Pokémon**	The game **Yu-Gi-Oh!**	Card maker **Topps**
Language	Only when not English **Blank**	Only when not English **Japanese**	Only when not English **Blank**	Only when not English **Blank**
Series	Product **Chrome Sapphire Edition**	Expansion **Scarlet & Violet 151**	Expansion **Legend of Blue Eyes White Dragon**	Product **Star Wars**
Card number	As printed, with # **#USA-WL**	As printed, with # **#199/165**	As printed, with # **#LOB-001**	As printed, with # **#1**

Rules

1 **One size per slot**
Text never shrinks to fit. A line that runs over uses its short form (rule 7).

2 **A dot between fields**
Fields on a line are joined by a middle dot (·). The slash is kept for serials, card numbers and multi-player names.

3 **# means card number**
Card numbers always start with #. Serials never do. That keeps #4/102 from being read as a print run.

4 **Language only when it is not English**
It prints straight after the manufacturer: 2023 Pokémon Japanese Pokémon Card 151.

5 **No repeats**
The subset drops words already in the series name. “Chrome Sapphire Autographs” in Chrome Sapphire Edition prints as “Autographs”.

6 **Line 2 is never blank**
Sports and non-sport print the subset or “Base”. Card games print the rarity.

7 **Short forms live in the card database**
A line that runs over prints the short form saved for that card: the publisher’s own short name or an approved abbreviation (Autograph to Auto). It is saved once, so every copy of the card gets the same label. Nobody shortens text at the print station.

8 **Two or more subjects**
Names are joined by a slash in the order printed on the card. Three or more: last names only.

9 **Team does not print**
It applies to sports only and does not identify the card. It stays in the grading report.

Type and position

For the production file. Label is 189 × 72 pt. Positions are in points from the top-left corner, measured on the current artwork.

ELEMENT	TYPE	POSITION
Subject	Brandon Grotesque Bold, 9 pt on 9.5 pt	Left 8.25. Baseline 37.76, second line above at 28.26. Width 91.6 beside two boxes, 132.4 beside one.
Version	Brandon Grotesque Medium, 7.5 pt	Left 8.25. Baseline 55.71.
Release	Brandon Grotesque Regular, 7.5 pt	Left 8.25. Baseline 64.71.
Serial and card number	Brandon Grotesque Medium, 7.5 pt	Right edge 180.75, on the Version and Release baselines. Keep 8 pt clear of the text to the left.
Grades, cert, box labels	Unchanged	Unchanged.
Box outlines	White stroke, 0.5 pt (was 0.25 pt)	Auto Grade, Card Grade and the four subgrade boxes. Box positions and sizes unchanged.
Back: QR code	21.07 pt square, dark modules on a white field	Left 159.68, top 42.68. Right edge 180.75 (the subgrade boxes), bottom 63.75 (the hologram). Quiet zone sits inside the square.
Back: cert number, date	Label Arial Narrow 7 pt, value Brandon Grotesque Medium 7 pt	Label left 68.53, value left 110. Baselines 51.39 and 59.88.
Line capacity	Estimated from the current artwork	Lines 2 and 3 are 172.5 pt wide, about 53 characters including the right-hand number and its gap. Subject holds about 19 characters beside two boxes and 28 beside one.

CURRENT LABEL, NEW TEMPLATE.

Same artwork and the same two cards. Only the information moves.

CURRENT · SPORTS CARD



1. One string of slashes that breaks wherever it runs out of room: “Chrome / Sapphire Autographs”.
2. The parallel, the part that drives value, comes last.
3. The serial sits by the logo, away from the parallel it belongs to.
4. The card number is buried in the middle of the string.

TEMPLATE · SAME CARD



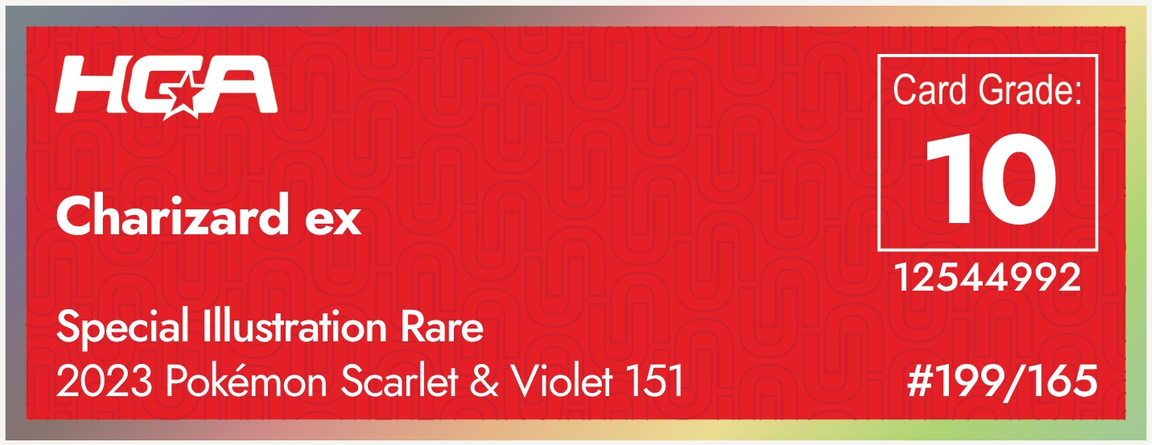
1. Each line has one job: who, which version, which release. Nothing wraps.
2. The parallel sits directly under the name.
3. The serial is on the parallel’s line, right-aligned under the cert.
4. The card number has its own place at the end of the release line. Grade box outlines are heavier.

CURRENT LAYOUT · POKÉMON CARD (MOCK-UP)



1. The team line has nothing to hold.
2. No slot for rarity, language or edition, so they land wherever the string has room.
3. “199/165” between slashes reads like a print run.

TEMPLATE · SAME CARD



1. The same three lines as the sports card. No empty line.
2. Rarity takes the subset slot. Language and edition have fixed places.
3. The # marks 199/165 as the card number.

HOW OTHER GRADERS ORDER THE FIELDS.

Field order only, drawn as plain rows. These are not their label designs. Read from each grader's published descriptions and from slabs in the market.

PSA

```
YEAR + SET                    #NUMBER
SUBJECT                  GRADE WORD
VARIETY                       GRADE
BARCODE                        CERT
```

WORTH TAKING

One layout for every card. Four fields that never change position.

NOT CARRIED OVER

All caps with hard abbreviations, and language folded into the set name.

CGC

```
SUBJECT                       GRADE
GAME · YEAR · LANGUAGE   GRADE WORD
SET + NUMBER
VARIANT                BACK: CERT, QR
```

WORTH TAKING

Subject first. Names and rarities spelled out. Language as its own field.

NOT CARRIED OVER

Type size that changes with the length of the text, and the variant on the last line, far from the name.

Beckett (BGS)

```
YEAR + SET                    GRADE
#NUMBER + SUBJECT
VARIATION
FOUR SUBGRADES                 CERT
```

WORTH TAKING

Subgrades printed on the label. HGA already does this, on the back.

NOT CARRIED OVER

Subgrades and card text sharing the front, which leaves little room for long names.

SGC

```
YEAR + SET                    GRADE
SUBJECT                  GRADE WORD
#NUMBER + VARIATION
CERT
```

WORTH TAKING

Few fields, and a grade that reads from across a table.

NOT CARRIED OVER

A layout built around vintage, with little space for modern parallels.

TAG

```
NO PAPER LABEL
CARD DATA PRINTED IN THE SLAB
GRADE + SCORE
CERT                     QR TO REPORT
```

WORTH TAKING

A QR code on every slab that opens the full grading report.

NOT CARRIED OVER

Text with no solid field behind it. The HGA red field keeps white type readable in photos.

ACE

```
NAME                          GRADE
RELEASE YEAR · SET · NUMBER
LANGUAGE
VARIANT                    SUBGRADES
```

WORTH TAKING

Language and Variant kept as separate, named fields in the cert record.

NOT CARRIED OVER

Label styles that change from card to card.

What the template takes

Fixed positions on every card. Subject first, spelled out. Language and variant as fields of their own. The version of the card directly under the name instead of last.

QR code on the back

PSA, CGC and TAG print a QR code that opens the cert record. The template now carries one bottom right on the back, pointing at the grading report.